PRODUCT DECISION MEMO / ECOMMERCE GROWTH

Simplified Checkout Experiment

TO
Ecommerce Product Manager

FROM
Product Analytics

DATE
31 July 2026

PROVISIONAL GO TO EXPERIMENT

DECISION

Advance a simplified checkout into a user-randomized A/B test.

Do not claim that the current checkout causes abandonment. Launch only after sticky exposure logging, a validated 24-hour purchase window, guardrails, current user throughput, the planning MDE, and the payment-error margin are approved.

360,129	5,187	48.02%	$306,678
VALID SESSIONS	CHECKOUT SESSIONS	CHECKOUT COMPLETION PROXY	CANONICAL GROSS REVENUE

01 / WHY THIS DECISION

Observed opportunity and measurement correction

OBSERVED OPPORTUNITY

Largest behavioral loss. Product view to cart retains 18.67%; 62,640 sessions are lost before cart.

Checkout is measurable. The governed population contains 5,187 starts and 2,491 clean purchases.

Broader scenario. A +0.50 pp checkout lift equals 25.9 orders and $1,793, versus 21.46 orders and $1,483.56 for the top single PDP.

No mobile deficit. Mobile purchase conversion is 1.15% versus 1.10% on Desktop; the difference interval includes zero.

MEASUREMENT CORRECTION

The 941 strict-path gaps are not 941 abandonments.

100% have shipping at or before the governed checkout start.

100% have payment after checkout and before purchase.

0 lack shipping everywhere in the session.

92.75% of checkout sessions repeat begin_checkout.

Implication: use a dedicated sticky exposure event and clean purchase within 24 hours as the primary outcome.

02 / ALTERNATIVES

What was considered and why it ranks lower

OPTION	EVIDENCE	DECISION
Simplify checkout	+0.50 pp scenario: 25.9 orders and $1,793; direct exposure and outcome can be instrumented.	**Advance to test**
Optimize top PDP	Super G Unisex Joggers: 21.46-order scenario; result is robust in rank but benchmark-sensitive and non-additive.	**Retain as secondary**
Mobile-only redesign	Mobile purchase conversion is not below Desktop; the 95% difference interval includes zero.	**Deprioritize**
Channel targeting	70.13% of sessions sit in weak-quality attribution buckets.	**Not decision-grade**

Confidence: sufficient to test, insufficient to ship. All 43 core and analysis-layer reconciliations passed; historical segment differences remain descriptive.

PRODUCT DECISION MEMO / IMPLEMENTATION CONTRACT

Experiment contract and launch gates

The design is reproducible, but the experiment is not launch-ready until assignment, outcomes, guardrails, and current throughput are validated at the user level.

03 / EXPERIMENT DESIGN

Locked planning rules

ELEMENT	LOCKED RULE
Control	Current checkout.
Treatment	One streamlined page combining shipping and payment; remove nonessential optional fields while preserving price, shipping, tax, order summary, accessibility, and trust disclosures.
Randomization	Sticky 50/50 assignment by pseudonymous user at first eligible checkout. Repeated checkout starts must not re-randomize.
Primary outcome	Clean purchase within 24 hours of first eligible exposure; intention-to-treat analysis.
Primary estimand	Treatment minus Control conversion in percentage points; pooled z-test and Newcombe interval at each look's boundary.
Secondary	Gross purchase revenue per eligible assigned user.
Guardrails	Payment-error rate (provisional +1.50 pp non-inferiority margin), refund or cancellation rate, and completion time.

04 / SAMPLE AND FEASIBILITY

The guardrail margin, not the MDE, sets the duration

48.02%	+5.00 pp	6,216	80%	15.8 wk
HISTORICAL BASELINE PROXY	PROVISIONAL MDE	MAX USERS, 4 LOOKS	SHIPS A TRUE +5 PP LIFT	MAX; 13.4 EXPECTED

+0.50 pp 25.9 orders / $1,793	**+2.00 pp** 103.7 orders / $7,172	**+5.00 pp** 259.4 orders / $17,930	**Important:** scenarios are not forecasts. Durations are optimistic until current unique-user throughput and the 24-hour baseline are measured.

05 / DECISION RULES

The first rule shipped a true +5 pp lift 29% of the time

1	**Integrity first.** Run the 50/50 sample-ratio-mismatch check at every look before reading outcomes. Stop if SRM $p < 0.001$.
2	**Ship on evidence.** Ship when the primary z reaches the look's O'Brien-Fleming boundary (4.05, 2.86, 2.34, 2.02). The point estimate is not compared with the MDE.
3	**Guardrails.** The payment-error upper bound must clear the +1.50 pp margin at the same confidence; stop for harm if its lower bound is above zero.
4	**Stopping discipline.** Read only at 25, 50, 75, and 100% of enrollment (daily unadjusted reads: 38% false positives). Stop for futility at the halfway look if the lift is not positive.

06 / LAUNCH GATES

Owners and evidence required before traffic is exposed

OWNER	REQUIRED BEFORE LAUNCH
Analytics	Validate sticky exposure, 24-hour clean-purchase attribution, current unique eligible users per day, the user-level baseline, and SRM monitoring.
Engineering	Prevent re-randomization and validate payment-error, refund or cancellation, and completion-time telemetry.
Payments + Product	Measure the payment-error rate, approve the margin that sets the duration, and confirm the +5.00 pp MDE.
Product + Design	Freeze the treatment and preserve disclosure, accessibility, price transparency, and user trust.

SIMULATION DISCLOSURE

The seeded example (true lift +5.00 pp) estimates +5.08 pp, z = 4.01, but misses the payment-error margin, so the rule does not ship. It is synthetic demonstration output.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Validate instrumentation and obtain sign-off, then run the user-randomized test. Do not ship from historical analysis or the seeded simulation.

Evidence base: Google GA4 public ecommerce sample, 2020-11-01 through 2021-01-31; aggregate run 20260731T052813Z; 43 of 43 hard checks passed. Open the public interactive dashboard.